■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, August 25, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Jodie Sweetin drops a wild marriage secret*

The Angle: *The 'Full House' alum is a three-time divorcée who says she's finally cracked the code on a happy marriage — and her answer is not what you'd expect. Instant curiosity bait for a live read.*

- **Jodie Sweetin** is opening up about her marriage to **Mescal Wasilewski**, now **4 years** in.
- She's a **three-time divorcée** before this marriage, which gives her take extra weight.
- Sweetin calls an **unconventional bedroom arrangement** the **"key"** to making this marriage work.

The Debate Starter

- Ask listeners: what's the one 'unconventional' rule that's actually saved your relationship?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/25/celebrity-news/jodie-sweetin-makes-bedroom-confession-about-mescal-wasilewski-marriage/

■ *Flock's CEO defends spy cameras after cops used them to stalk exes*

The Angle: *Flock's license-plate cameras are quietly watching neighborhoods across North America, and now the company's CEO is doing damage control after a Washington Post investigation found cops abusing the tech - this is a real 'wait, THAT'S watching me?' story for anyone driving through a Flock-covered town.*

- **The Washington Post** identified **46 cases** of police officers accused of misusing Flock technology for unauthorized purposes.
- Some of those officers allegedly used the surveillance tech to **stalk their own wives, girlfriends, or exes**.
- CEO **Garrett Langley** has been on a media tour (Fox News, CBS News) defending the company amid growing public backlash.
- Langley's defense: **"I value my privacy... but what we're talking about is safety as well"** - arguing privacy vs. safety is 'the wrong' framing and the country needs 'compromise.'

The Debate Starter

- Would you trade a little privacy for cameras that catch criminals - even after hearing cops used them to stalk their exes?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/n3coaoakvdlh1

■■ *Democrat blasts streamer Hasan Piker as a 'hate' hack*

The Angle: *A sitting Democrat publicly torching a prominent left-wing streamer over his comments on Israel and American Jews is a rare intra-party dust-up — it taps into the bigger, ongoing fight over how Democrats talk about Israel right now.*

- A **Democrat** publicly called streamer **Hasan Piker** a **"hack who thrives on hate"**
- The criticism was aimed at Piker's **warning to American Jews** about **Israel**
- The clash spilled onto social media, amplified by outlets like the **NY Post**

The Debate Starter

- When does 'political commentary' cross the line into something that alarms the very community it claims to be warning?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2092204112515313848

■ *A copper plate bolted to the back of a solar panel catches the 80 percent of sunlight that never becomes electricity, lifts the panel's output by 59.3 percent, sends that heat into a reactor pulling bagged fertilizer out of real human urine, and the startup is selling to slaughterhouses*

The Angle: *A copper plate bolted to the back of a solar panel catches the 80 percent of sunlight that never becomes electricity, lifts the panel's output by 59.3 percent, sends that heat into a reactor pulling bagged fertilizer out of real human urine, and the startup is selling to slaughterhouses*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.autonocion.com/us/copper-plate-solar-panel-urine-fertilizer/

■ *A16Z is pouring billions into AI - is that good news?*

The Angle: *One of Silicon Valley's biggest venture firms is doubling down hard on AI, and the framing already has people arguing about whether that's exciting innovation or a warning sign for jobs and society.*

The Debate Starter

- Are we more excited or more nervous when we hear a VC giant is betting billions on where AI takes us next?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.modelrepublic.org/articles/a16z-portfolio

Backup options:

■■ *Doug Ford Tells Trump To 'Kiss My Ass'*

The Angle: *A sitting Canadian premier going scorched-earth on the U.S. president in public is rare, blunt, and instantly clip-worthy — especially with cross-border trade tension already simmering.*

- **Doug Ford**, Premier of Ontario, publicly told **Donald Trump** to "kiss my ass"
- The line is ripping through **Reddit's r/canada** under a "BREAKING" tag
- Comes amid ongoing friction between **Canada** and the **Trump administration** over trade

The Debate Starter

- Is Ford saying out loud what a lot of Canadians are already thinking, or did a premier just cross a line?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thetrillium.ca/news/politics/breaking-doug-ford-on-donald-trump-he-can-kiss-my-ass-12698504

■■ *Vance calls Canada 'a state' — same day Trump says no more special treatment*

The Angle: *Two of the most powerful men in the US just publicly dismissed Canada's sovereignty on the same day — that's not a gaffe, that's a message, and it's got Canadians (and cross-border listeners) fuming.*

- **VP JD Vance** referred to Canada as a **"state"** rather than a sovereign country
- The comment came just **hours after President Trump** said Canada would **"no longer be treated"** the way it has been
- Story is circulating heavily on **r/canada**, suggesting real anger/engagement north of the border
- Timing of the two comments same-day is fueling speculation this is coordinated messaging, not a slip

The Debate Starter

- Is this just Trump-world trolling, or a real shift in how the US is going to treat its closest neighbor?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.washingtontimes.com/news/2026/aug/24/jd-vance-calls-canada-state-hours-trump-says-no-longer-treated-like/

■ *Golf cart guy gets slapped with a $183K car tariff*

The Angle: *A federal tariff built to hit Chinese electric cars just landed on a small Ontario business owner who sells golf trolleys — the kind of bureaucratic mix-up that writes itself as a "government red tape gone wrong" story with national reach.*

- The business owner is based in **Pickering, Ont.**
- He's being hit with a **$183,000** bill
- The tariff was designed to target **Chinese-made electric vehicles**, not golf trolleys
- The federal EV tariff in question is reportedly **now defunct**

The Debate Starter

- Should small businesses have to fight government red tape like this just to prove a golf cart isn't a car?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/toronto/pickering-golf-trolley-china-surtax-order-9.7317888?cmp=rss

---

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *PM Carney unveils $11 billion in funding to make 6 icebreakers in Quebec*

The Angle: *PM Carney unveils $11 billion in funding to make 6 icebreakers in Quebec*

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://montreal.citynews.ca/2026/08/24/carney-icebreakers-quebec-shipbuilding/

■ *Carney walked away from Trump's trade deal — here's why*

The Angle: *Canada's biggest industries were reportedly on the chopping block, and the PM says he blew up the table rather than sign off on it — this is the kind of economic news that hits jobs on both sides of the border.*

- **PM Mark Carney** says he walked away from a deal with the **Trump administration**
- Carney claims Washington's terms would **"destroy"** Canada's biggest industries
- The industries at risk: **auto, steel, and aluminum**
- **CBC News** learned what was actually on the table and why the talks collapsed

The Debate Starter

- Was Carney right to walk, or did Canada just lose leverage by refusing to deal?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/carney-trump-trade-talks-broke-down-9.7318903?cmp=rss

---

■ *Yellowknife Woman Paid Thousands Just to Get Diagnosed*

The Angle: *A stark look at the healthcare gap in Canada's North — a Yellowknife woman had to leave the territory and pay out of pocket just to find out she has a terminal disease, something most Canadians never have to think about.*

- **Mary Rose Blackduck**, of **Yellowknife**, was diagnosed with **ALS** (amyotrophic lateral sclerosis)
- She had to leave the **Northwest Territories** and pay **thousands of dollars** out of pocket to see a specialist
- ALS attacks the nervous system and damages muscle function
- Typical life expectancy after an ALS diagnosis is just **two to five years**

The Debate Starter

- Should someone have to fly out of their own territory and pay thousands out of pocket just to get diagnosed?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/north/als-nwt-healthcare-alberta-9.7313238?cmp=rss

Backup options:

✂■ *Haaland shaves the Viking locks — fans are in mourning*

The Angle: *Erling Haaland's flowing blond mane has basically been his brand since he exploded onto the scene — so when the Man City superstar showed up with a full buzz cut, social media treated it like a national tragedy. It's a goofy, low-stakes debate that's tailor-made for a quick back-and-forth on air.*

- **Erling Haaland**, Manchester City's star striker, debuted a brand-new buzz cut on **Sunday**
- Fans flooded social media reacting to the drastic change
- One widely shared reaction declared: **"The Viking era is over"**

The Debate Starter

- Does a haircut actually change how an athlete performs, or is this just fans being dramatic over nothing?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/erling-haaland-hair-9.7318164?cmp=rss

---

■ *Canada Set to Hit Back With Tariffs on the U.S. Tuesday*

The Angle: *This is a fresh escalation in the ongoing Canada-U.S. trade fight, and it hits pocketbooks on both sides of the border - if you buy anything cross-border or work in an affected industry, this is the kind of story that turns into dinner-table debate fast.*

- **CTV News** sources say Canada is preparing to announce **retaliatory tariffs** against the U.S.
- The announcement is expected **Tuesday**
- Details on which goods/industries get hit haven't been made public yet

The Debate Starter

- Trade fights always trickle down to regular people's wallets - what's the first cross-border product you'd hate to see get more expensive?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi1gFBVV95cUxPSXZZQ3Zxdmd2Q2Rkbkk5QXhiVTR1ZS1oZUlmRnd2azdMa0RDZTF1VXRRVFNlQjhxdWxuTVFXTG5WYUpJaGtTSlRicF9LMDl5VThBVmEtNkRSLUEzRWU0NFBJdmpRd1hXZnpQckR6STZxV2pEUl9Ca3YyS0ZXX002N19MMlNfd3RfOFVNR0g0VFdTeVJBUnR0TmZSMl92b2Job3RORzRoRERTXzNCdzdZeF9LN2ZSbnhPdXJycTktdm4wblNhTWdrUThRS09lX081eXN1VGl3?oc=5

■■ *Is Trump actually turning up the heat on Canada?*

The Angle: *Cross-border tension always gets a Canadian audience talking, especially when it's framed as an escalation - this is the kind of story that touches trade, politics, and national pride all at once.*

The Debate Starter

- Is this real pressure Canada needs to worry about, or just more noise we've learned to tune out?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirwFBVV95cUxNaXFYSXdiSVkyRzBvaTlwUmhHNUNqM0JDRGRtUFFIUkR3WjZ3elA1NkVTbEpLWTU3RTgtU2tYT0pMRWpKRHZMX2xYSUhLTkMxMXloeEZHUmlpTjFlS2tObmJBMUF2ajJzeC1FWExoOFFfYWxHY19MMHQxd0R6d0xPZnFpOVFYTENnaDZoR3ZNY1hWaWVERi1uNnFtVUFkdkZvakNwWXZNNGFtN25YYUEw?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Alice Cooper's Secret 70s Vampire Club Gets The Movie Treatment*

The Angle: *Alice Cooper and Aerosmith's Joe Perry are showing up in person to talk about a documentary on their old secret drinking club that became the supergroup Hollywood Vampires — big rock star names plus a*

wild origin story is an easy watercooler hook.

- **Alice Cooper**, **Joe Perry** and **Tommy Henriksen** are set to appear at the **42nd Boston Film Festival**
- They're there for the opening night premiere of **"Unleashed Spirits: The Rise of the Hollywood Vampires"**
- The film traces Cooper's secret **1970s "drinking and social club"**
- That club eventually became the rock supergroup **Hollywood Vampires**

The Backstory Hook

- Alice Cooper basically had a secret rock star clubhouse in the 70s that turned into a real band decades later — ask listeners who they'd want in their own celebrity 'secret club.'

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/hollywood-vampires-film-open-boston-film-festival-1236842118/

■■ *Window Film Lets This Sun-Allergic Toddler Finally Play in Daylight*

The Angle: *A simple fix - a UV-blocking film on the windows - gave a little kid with a rare sun allergy something most families take for granted: playing in the light. It's the kind of small-scale, feel-good story that's an easy palate-cleanser between heavier segments.*

- A **toddler** has a **sun allergy** that made daylight exposure a problem.
- A **UV-blocking window film** was installed to filter out the rays triggering the reaction.
- The fix let the child **play safely in daylight** for the first time.

The Feel-Good Takeaway

- Sometimes the fix for a huge problem is something as small as a strip of film on a window.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c3053n15r78o

■ *Australia just banned AI songs from its charts*

The Angle: *AI music is flooding streaming services, and now Australia's music industry is drawing a hard line by keeping AI-generated tracks off official charts — a preview of the fight every country's music business is about to have.*

- **Australia's music industry** has officially banned **AI-generated songs** from appearing on its charts
- Move comes as AI music tools flood streaming platforms with machine-made tracks

The Debate Starter

- Should AI-made songs even be allowed to compete with human artists, or does this ban set the standard every country should follow?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://apnews.com/article/australia-ai-generated-music-charts-ban-aria-9bfb0c91166ae4405a6df1a3c4891687

■ *Netherlands Ditches Eurovision Again Over Israel Fight*

The Angle: *Eurovision's supposed to be pure kitsch and key changes, but it's turning into a real political flashpoint - and this is the Netherlands walking out for the second year running, not a one-off protest.*

- **The Netherlands** is boycotting **Eurovision** for the **second year in a row**
- Their reasoning: the contest has become a **"platform for division"**
- They say Eurovision is **"no longer neutral"**
- The sticking point is **Israel's** continued participation in the competition

The Debate Starter

- Should a glittery song contest be taking political stances at all, or is sitting it out exactly the right move?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.euronews.com/culture/2026/08/24/netherland-withdraws-from-2027-eurovision-song-contest-says-competition-no-longer-neutral

Backup options:

■ *Fired for Charlie Kirk Posts — Now She's Getting Her Job Back*

The Angle: *A Washington Post columnist just won her job back in arbitration after getting canned over posts about Charlie Kirk — it's a fresh flashpoint in the ongoing fight over what journalists are allowed to say online, and it's got the media world buzzing.*

- **Karen Attiah**, an opinion columnist at **The Washington Post**, was fired over posts she made about **Charlie Kirk**
- An arbitrator sided with her and ordered the **Post to reinstate her**
- She's also set to collect **back pay** for the time she was out of a job

The Debate Starter

- Should a newspaper be able to fire a columnist over their personal takes on a public figure — or does this feel like a win for free speech?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thewrap.com/media-platforms/journalism/karen-attiah-washington-post-reinstated-arbitration/

■ *Chanel's "barefoot sandals" just claimed their first red carpet victim*

The Angle: *Margaret Qualley showed up at a London premiere basically shoeless in a designer gown, and it turns out she's not even the first A-lister to go barefoot on the carpet — this is a whole weird trend hosts can rank.*

- **Margaret Qualley** wore Chanel's controversial **"barefoot sandals"** to the London premiere of **"The Dog Stars"**
- She paired the half-shoes with a **black embellished gown**
- **Kristen Stewart** is name-checked as another star who's gone barefoot on the red carpet before her

The Debate Starter

- Hot fashion risk or just... wearing no shoes? Get the hosts to vote.

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Pull up the pic** - 30 seconds -> Hosts describe Margaret Qualley's "barefoot sandal" look for listeners who can't see it
- **Step 2: Hot or Not vote** - 1 minute -> Each host declares the look genius or ridiculous, no hedging allowed
- **Step 3: Name that celeb** - 1-2 minutes -> Hosts try to guess other stars (like Kristen Stewart) who've pulled the barefoot carpet move before reveal
- **Step 4: Phone-in vote** - Open lines -> Ask listeners to call/text: would you ever go barefoot for a big event?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/video/from-margaret-qualley-to-kristen-stewart-all-the-celebrities-who-have-gone-barefoot-on-the-red-carpet/

■ *Dodgers-Braves Is Basically a Playoff Preview*

The Angle: *Late August and this series already has October stakes — a first-round bye and home-field edge could hinge on it, so it's way bigger than a random weekday matchup.*

- It's just a **three-game series** in late August — but it's playing like a playoff preview.
- A **first-round bye** could be riding on this set for one of these teams.
- **Home-field advantage** for October is reportedly part of what's on the line.

The Debate Starter

- Dodgers or Braves — who do you actually want to see standing in October?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/25/sports/dodgers-series-with-braves-have-massive-playoff-implications/

■ *A horror movie just out-earned every franchise this decade*

The Angle: *In an era of endless sequels and reboots, a totally original horror flick just crossed half a billion dollars worldwide — that's a genuine underdog story Hollywood loves to talk about.*

- **Obsession**, from filmmaker **Curry Barker**, just crossed **$500 million** at the global box office.
- It's now officially the **highest-grossing original film of the decade** — no sequel, no reboot, no existing IP attached.
- It did it purely on the horror genre, which keeps proving it can out-earn bigger, more expensive tentpoles.

The Debate Starter

- Does this prove original stories can still beat franchises at the box office, or is horror just the one genre where audiences will always take a gamble?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/obsession-is-the-highest-grossing-original-film-of-the-decade-2000802592

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Record-breaking lightning strikes*

The Angle: *Record-breaking lightning strikes*

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMijAFBVV95cUxNXzNmWWRUS0EyWE1KYV85bURMcHJJdnBXSnlqM1VqMXgzdVlXazU3NFBzTHJQQVRFRWFOZmRGNGdrQUM3QlV2aDRzNjN0QjNyS2pUa1FPZDJLWU1PQllsSmNOM0RhX3lGVEJsUjlodmhwM2xtSHNNUTFmNXNLckw0ZmR0Z0tCMHBkTHNXbg?oc=5

Backup options:

■ *Target pulls a Halloween costume after racism backlash*

The Angle: *Target is apologizing after social media accused one of its kids' costumes of echoing a racist caricature — a retail fumble that's blowing up online right as Halloween shopping season kicks off.*

- The costume **sparked backlash on social media** almost immediately after shoppers spotted it.
- Critics say it **resembled a racist caricature**, not just a generic bad design choice.
- **Target** has issued an apology in response to the outcry.

The Debate Starter

- Where's the line between an innocent costume design and a company just not thinking it through?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/life/fashion-beauty/target-sorry-offensive-costume-backlash

---

■ *Target yanks a clown costume and actually says sorry*

The Angle: *A major national retailer publicly admitting 'we got this wrong' is rare corporate honesty, and clown costumes always spark a strong reaction right before Halloween shopping season kicks in.*

- **Target** pulled a clown Halloween costume from shelves after customer backlash
- The company issued a public apology note admitting **'We got this wrong'**
- Timing lines up with peak Halloween costume shopping season

The Debate Starter

- Where's the line between a spooky costume and one that's genuinely too much - and did Target overreact by pulling it?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiugFBVV95cUxNeEVhSFgtcThvZExGRENfTzREVHJ6ZGs5YUp6S2w1RkxjWmtDOUd5aHdfdjhrcnMzeVltajg4ZFlpa2lzSjVpZHY4c0hMYWl2QkhOYk9XSUkzZkJjUy1wRUFmUXBmckJmTy1helJJc0lEalR3eTNaOF9RRUdBT2FNWHlmbEc3aGkyN1ZHbE5UUC1GWHZNUnZjWkNnNzc0ZzFGX25VMDF1Zm00aW9OeGxpbWJhV2R4THVQRnc?oc=5

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Your shampoo's lying to you — new study says 85% hide a mystery chemical*

The Angle: *Everyone's got a cabinet full of this stuff — soap, lotion, cleaning spray — and this study says most of it isn't telling you the whole truth on the label. That's an easy 'go check your bathroom right now' moment for listeners.*

- A new study found **85%** of personal care and cleaning products tested had **at least one undisclosed chemical** not listed on the label.
- The chemical was described as **'potentially harmful'** — flagged, but not necessarily proven dangerous in daily use.
- Products in question span both **personal care** (think shampoo, lotion, soap) and **household cleaning** items.

The Cabinet Check

- Callers — go grab whatever's under your sink or in your shower right now, what's actually on that label?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pubs.acs.org/ehnea2/article/doi/10.1021/envhealth.6c00181/5252510/Hidden-Hazards-Nontargeted-Chemical-Analysis?_kx=XNWwVJyA8PLpY0aFJp1XnhL1qc4uFux9_6KFyk6kc5Y.TNuYmj

Backup options:

■ *Screen time at age 1 and 6 could shape your kid for life*

The Angle: *Every parent's already fighting the screen time battle, and new research suggesting two very specific ages matter most is exactly the kind of guilt-trip headline that gets parents texting each other immediately.*

The Guilt Check

- Call in and tell us honestly - how much screen time did your kid get before age 6, and do you think it messed them up?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencedaily.com/releases/2026/08/260823094152.htm

---

■ *Could Alzheimer's spread through a blood transfusion?*

The Angle: *A new Lancet review digs into the wild idea that Alzheimer's isn't just genetic or age-related but could actually be transmissible, like a pathogen, through sticky amyloid-beta proteins passed via blood transfusions - the kind of medical curveball that makes people rethink something they assumed was totally settled.*

- The theory: **Alzheimer's-linked amyloid-beta proteins** may be able to spread between people, not just develop independently in each brain
- A new review in **The Lancet** examines evidence that these harmful proteins could potentially be transmitted through **blood transfusions**
- This builds on a growing body of research from recent years suggesting Alzheimer's could behave more like an infectious process than previously thought

The Debate Starter

- Would this change how you feel about needing a blood transfusion someday - and should blood banks even be screening for this?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/can-alzheimers-spread-through-blood-transfusions-heres-what-we-know

---

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Real-life couple teams up on screen for Sheriff Country*

The Angle: *Morena Baccarin and Ben McKenzie are married in real life and now sharing a set for Season 2 - that kind of behind-the-scenes couple chemistry is easy, fun tease material for the show.*

- **Morena Baccarin** is bringing her husband **Ben McKenzie** on board for **Sheriff Country** Season 2.
- The two are a real-life married couple stepping into the same show together.
- They reportedly made the news public with a **funny announcement**, per **People.com**.

The Script Hits

- Would you want your spouse showing up as your co-star at work - or is that a hard pass?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiywFBVV95cUxPcDFIWF9XanlfbW5sX1FiTEd1WklGTmtwQ1lQcjBTRlA5cTBLMzFhdk05eWswOG9XOThja0Z5NEdrUFdjRE1RLVhOcm9jS1dOZTZwUDh5ZURYQWtvcUktThqMUpXcUJTNUVPZkgtb0JKdVNKZXMyWThSYTFKOFVOMTA2WEc5aGppTnVnNXRfbnZ1ZXZzVklXWHZYaDlrQ2trd09VVUF6TndhUlNDZXRvVjZ6Z3hMMmdwdG1kN2h0OGwxWGVEWF8yNGVaNA?oc=5

Backup options:

■ *30 big cats just traded a concrete cage for a real life*

The Angle: *It's the ultimate glow-up story - lions and tigers stuck in cramped concrete pens at a shut-down Argentine zoo are finally getting shipped out to real sanctuaries, and rescuers made sure not to break up the families.*

- **30 lions and tigers** relocated from a former zoo in **Argentina**
- New homes are sanctuaries in **South Africa** and the **US**
- The animals lived for years in **cramped concrete enclosures**
- **Family groups were kept together** during the move, with lifelong specialist care ahead

The Feel-Good Finish

- This is the kind of story you end the show on - a happy ending that didn't have to happen, but somebody made it happen anyway.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.four-paws.org.za/our-stories/press-releases/international-rescue-effort-spanning-three-continents

---

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Murder rate in America just hit a 70-year low*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An 18% homicide drop to a nearly 70-year low directly contradicts the dominant 'crime is surging' narrative, making it exactly the kind of counter-intuitive stat that gets aggressively shared to win arguments.
The Angle: *This one cuts against the doom-scroll narrative — actual FBI numbers show violent crime is falling hard and fast, and it's happening nationwide, not just in one city, which makes it a real 'wait, really?' moment for listeners.*

- **U.S. homicides dropped 18.1%** in 2025, according to the **FBI**
- That's the **lowest homicide rate since 1956** — pre-dates most listeners' parents

- Analysts project the rate will keep falling and could hit the **lowest ever recorded** in 2026

The Reality Check

- Does this match what you're feeling in your own city, or does it feel more dangerous out there than the numbers say?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://abcnews.com/Politics/wireStory/homicides-dropped-181-2025-lowest-rate-1956-fbi-135658661

■■ *Ukraine's amputee war vets just crushed a brutal endurance race*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Same story is simultaneously running on CTVNews (index 34) with independent traction, and the amputee-veteran endurance-challenge hook has the strong emotional pull that reliably outperforms its initial numbers.
The Angle: *It's a resilience story with real teeth - veterans who lost limbs in the war using their country's independence day to prove what they can still do, not what they lost. That's the kind of story that cuts through the daily war-news fatigue.*

- **Ukrainian amputee veterans** took part in a grueling endurance challenge to mark the country's **independence day**
- The event doubles as both a national celebration and a public statement of resilience from wounded soldiers

The Inspiration Hook

- Ask listeners: what's the toughest physical comeback you've ever witnessed someone make?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/world/russia-ukraine-war/article/ukraines-amputee-veterans-celebrate-independence-day-with-grueling-endurance-challenge/

■ *Ukraine's Amputee Vets Just Crushed an Endurance Challenge*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Cross-platform duplication of this Ukraine amputee-veteran story (also posted by r/upliftingnews as index 2) is an early momentum signal that the angle is resonating beyond one audience.
The Angle: *On Ukraine's independence day, wounded soldiers who lost limbs in the war are pushing their bodies to the limit in a grueling endurance event — a resilience story with real emotional weight amid ongoing war coverage.*

- The event ties directly to **Ukraine's independence day**
- Participants are **amputee military veterans**, many injured in the ongoing war
- The challenge is described as **grueling** and endurance-based

The Perspective Check

- What's the toughest thing you've ever pushed through — and would it hold up next to this?

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2091983995609219168

■ *Company Named "Hugging Face" Worth $13 Billion?*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Hugging Face is one of the most recognizable names in AI and a $13B valuation headline lands squarely in the ongoing AI-bubble-or-not conversation dominating tech discourse.
The Angle: *It's the kind of headline that sounds fake but isn't - a startup literally called Hugging Face is reportedly fielding buyout interest at a $13 billion price tag, prime real estate for r/nottheonion and a fun way to close the show on the AI money boom.*

- **Hugging Face** is reportedly exploring a possible sale.
- The number being floated: a **$13 billion** valuation.
- Yes, that's the company's actual name - **Hugging Face**.

The Kicker Line

- Somewhere out there, "Hugging Face" is worth more than half the airlines you've flown - AI money has officially gone surreal.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://frontbackgeek.com/hugging-face-exploring-sale-at-13-billion-valuation/

■ *Nvidia Tech Is Turning Up Inside Russia's War Drones*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Nvidia hardware ending up in Russian drones is a naming-and-shaming story that combines a marquee tech brand with a live war controversy, the kind of combo that draws outrage-driven shares.
The Angle: *American chipmaker Nvidia's hardware allegedly showing up in Moscow's AI-powered drones is a sanctions-evasion story with real geopolitical teeth — it raises the question of how US tech keeps slipping into a wartime enemy's hands.*

- Report claims **Nvidia-made minicomputers** are being used to power **AI drones** built in **Moscow**
- Raises fresh questions about how Western tech companies' hardware is getting around sanctions and into Russia's war effort
- Nvidia has previously said it doesn't support unauthorized use of its products in Russia

The Debate Starter

- Should tech companies be on the hook when their hardware ends up powering a war machine, even if it got there through backchannels?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/08/24/world/europe/ukraine-war-nvidia-ai-autonomous-drones.html?unlocked_article_code=1.71A.EAVn.IF90QN5npz8-&smid=url-share

---

■ *Turns Out Screen Time Might Be Making Kids Smarter*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An 8-year Finnish study finding screen time correlates with better teen cognition inverts the conventional 'screens are bad for kids' wisdom, which is catnip for parent-and-education discourse.
The Angle: *Every parent's been told screens fry kids' brains — but this one flips the script and gives guilt-ridden parents (and hosts who let their own kids binge YouTube) some cover.*

- Researchers in **Finland** tracked the same kids' screen habits for **8 years**
- The study was designed to prove screens damage cognitive development
- Teens who logged **more** screen time actually showed **better** cognitive processing
- The result ran directly against what the researchers expected to find

The Parent Guilt-Trip Buster

- Does this finally get you off the hook for handing over the iPad at dinner?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.jyu.fi/en/news/more-screen-time-since-childhood-associated-with-better-cognitive-processing-in-adolescence

---

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)
- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt https://t.co/HwXL2" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-13)
- "Hayden Panettiere was haunted by crippling back pain from bizarre on-set zebra accident" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-19)
- "Abdul El-Sayed asks Fox News' Jesse Watters 'Are you circumcised?' in bizarre moment as he defends sex change surgery for minors https://t.c" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-24)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 15 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn't Invited to Partake in 'Wizards of Waverly Place' Revival: "Disappointed"" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
- "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
- "Where to Watch 'Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th' Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
- "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
- ""Roseanne" Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)
- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)
- "Chip Gaines Makes Rare Appearance with Wife Joanna on Magnolia Journal's Milestone 10th Anniversary Cover - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "'Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "Ugly inning, quiet bats doom Yankees in disappointing loss to Blue Jays" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-14)
- "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she's sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)
- "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to "The Fast and the Furious" 25th Anniversary Screening in LA https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)
- "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt 'Disappointed' by BLACKPINK's 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)
- "Pokémon 30th Anniversary TCG Set Might Feature Rarest Mew Ever - Kotaku" (Kotaku (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-21)
- "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite's 'Override' Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 3 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-25 09:10 AM